



Subcultures go mainstream

What happens when internet subcultures are unexpectedly exposed to the mainstream? <https://digit.in/sep18-58-1>



Cars before automobiles

Motorig, Truckle, Mocole and Diamote are just some of the terrible names that were given to horseless carriages. <https://digit.in/sep18-58-2>

Good Guy Dark Web

When the darkness was helpful

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he internet as we know it has been around for long enough for their to be 4.62 billion indexed

web pages out there, as of 2016. Today, in 2018, that number could have only gone up, perhaps even multiple times. However, this might comprise of a mere 5%, or even lesser according to some estimates, of the entire web. The rest is something known as the Deep Web, or that part of the internet that is not indexed by search engines. For example, there is a ton of data in your email and personal cloud storage, which exists on the internet, but does not appear on the "surface" web. The Dark Web though, is an entirely different thing. It has been built to dodge censorship and allow the spread of peer to peer content. Common Dark Web networks include Tor, Freenet and Riffle. While the Deep Web can be accessed by the general public and through normal browsers, the Dark Web has been intentionally built to be hidden and anonymous. Usually, most of the news coverage associated with the dark web has been negative - and this is not ill founded - since the anonymity it offers has given rise to a large amount of illicit and illegal activity taking place

in its domain. However, with each instance of something horrible or illegal, there are also instances where the same dark web has been used to take such things down - actions resulting in outcomes that have helped us and made the world a better place. Here, we're going to focus on the good deeds of the dark web.

FACEBOOK

One of the main reasons for using Tor is that it provides safety and privacy. Additionally, web sites hosted on the Dark Web allow its users to dodge government censorships. Facebook officially introduced its services on the Dark Web in 2014. On mobile devices, Facebook on the Dark Web can be accessed through an app known as Orbot. The way Tor works is that it anonymises the source IP of a user, by constantly switching them through volunteer relays around the world. If a user wanted to enjoy this cryptographic protection while using Facebook, without the official version they would be locked out. This was because Facebook would detect the IP switching from say Australia to Sweden to Canada, it would flag the user as suspicious. This is how bots, not humans typically appear to Facebook. Facebook introduced the official .onion url, so that users who wanted to browse Facebook through Tor, could continue to do so.

THE CHILD PORN KAMIKAZE

Not everybody is onboard with what hacktivism stands for. Events of the recent past have shown us that hacktivism can cut both ways, no matter which side of the fence you're standing on. However, there are certain actions that put hacktivist groups like Anonymous on the side of those fighting for the greater good. In february 2017, an anonymous hacker, part of the namesake group, took down over 10,000 pages on the dark web related to child pornography.

We know what you're going to say. "If those websites were on the dark web, doesn't that itself make the dark web bad?". The answer to that is slightly complicated. While there does exist illegal content, the dark web has also provided an anonymous platform for hacktivism to thrive. About a couple of years ago, members of Anonymous had started OnionIRC, a hidden platform on the dark web for sharing technical skills in hacking and the use of anonymity software.

In this instance, the hacktivist took down Freedom Hosting II, a hosting service provider to one fifth of the dark web accessible only through Tor, the anonymous web browser. While the vigilante's original intention was to observe the sites hosted on FHII, they discovered that a large portion of the sites hosted were dedicated to child pornography which also crossed the